

Design report & Archive guidelines (JM0110, April 2026)

Introduction

The design process can be understood as an iterative succession of five phases:

- Empathize
- Define
- Ideate
- Prototype
- Test

Once you have taken each of these five steps, you have only done **one** iteration. You will know how your design should be improved to match the users' needs and requirements better. You will provide these enhancements by visualizing them in an improved version of the design concept (new sketches and/or prototypes) or describing suggestions for further improvement. You do not need to test the improved design.

In this UX design assignment, we guide you through the entire process (one iteration). Each workshop addresses one step in the design process.

The design report should give insight into the design process you followed, the design that resulted from it, and the rationale behind that design. To ensure the traceability of your design decisions, you will also keep an archive of the raw data you gathered, and the insights that you gathered from them. This document will help you understand what we expect from both the design report and the data archive.

Note that we take design broadly: it can mean the design of a new interface, tool, layout, but also the design and analysis of a specific study or experiment. We will use the rubric in a flexible way to accommodate both.

The design report (40 points)

In the design report, we want to be able to see that you:

- [Process, 4 points] Have structured your design process by iteratively following the five phases of design thinking;

Poor (0 points)	Acceptable (1 point)	Good (2 points)
The design report isn't structured according to the five design thinking phases.	The design report shows how the group has followed the five phases of design thinking (empathize, define, ideate, prototype and test).	The design report shows a well-argued journey of the five phases of design thinking (empathize, define, ideate, prototype and test).

- [Empathize, 6 points] Have gained a thorough and rich understanding of the problem space and the potential user group by using pilot testing with qualitative research techniques and/or technical inspection of current XAI tools and/or literature research;

Poor (0 points)	Acceptable (4 points)	Good (6 points)
The group has used no pilot testing, or technical inspection or literature search, showing very low understanding of the problem space.	One or two ways of engaging with the problem space and users have been used and motivated to some extent, and were used to come to reasonable insights into the problem space and user group.	Two or three carefully selected and well-motivated approaches were used to come to highly relevant and well-explained insights into the problem space and user group.

- [Define, 2 points] Are capable of determining a relevant focus in the design assignment, based on rich user and XAI technology insights;

Poor (0 points)	Acceptable (1 point)	Good (2 points)
The insights gained in the empathizing phase were ignored or made subordinate to other considerations.	The insights gained from empathizing phase were used to define the problem space, but the way in which these have been taken as a focus for the ideation phase is unclear.	The insights gained from user research were used to define the problem space, which were taken as a clear and well explained focus for the ideation phase.

- [Ideate, 8 points] Have explored a wide diversity of potential solutions, before making a relevant choice for (a combination of) solution(s), founded on your understanding of the user group;

Poor (0 points)	Acceptable (5 points)	Good (8 points)
The report presents only one solution that is created without exploring alternatives. And Arguments to continue developing the one solution further are not based on XAI and/or user needs.	Multiple alternative solutions have been created using at least one creative technique (divergence), but they're quite similar to each other. And After creating alternative solutions, a choice is made for one direction (convergence),	Multiple alternative solutions have been created using at least one creative technique (divergence), which cover a wide diversity of opportunities for innovation. And After creating alternative solutions, a choice is made for one

	but this choice is made implicitly or based on arguments other than XAI and user needs.	direction (convergence), explicitly based on XAI and user needs.
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- [Prototype, 8 points] Have created at least one prototype that allows learning from the user group about what improvements need to be made to fit their needs and requirements better; The prototype encompasses the essential step in the interaction with the user, and has a realistic / good model / XAI output. (i.e. uses actual user data to provide a realistic prediction, and/or uses an actual model in the background that can be interacted with)

Note that we also consider doing a more survey/experiment-like as a 'prototype' , but then we will assess the quality of the survey setup and experimental design in this rubric. In that case it will focus more on the quality/fidelity of the stimuli and questions used...

Poor (0 points)	Acceptable (5 points)	Good (8 points)
There is no prototype for user testing.	The group built at least one prototype.	The group built at least one prototype.
Or	And	And
The prototype created is not suitable for the XAI and user testing goals	The prototype covers aspects of the design concept that makes it suitable for the XAI and user testing goals, but the levels of fidelity and interactivity are inappropriate for this testing goal. (e.g. limited interaction or no realistic model output)	The prototype covers aspects of the design concept and is created with suitable levels of fidelity and interactivity that make it appropriate for the XAI and user testing goals. (e.g. good interaction and realistic model output)

- [Test, 8 points] Have shown an open and receptive attitude to feedback from a variety of users in a structured prototype test or user study (and analysis);

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Poor (0 points)	Acceptable (5 points)	Good 8 (points)
No real prototype test with users is performed / the user study was done in a very limited way, or with very few users.	A prototype test/user study is performed with multiple users, but the test/study is lacking in a clear structure or explicit testing goals.	A structured prototype test / user study is performed with at a sufficiently large sample of users that fits explicit testing goals.
Or	And	And
The prototype test / user study is not documented in a way that shows the resulting insights	The prototype test / user study has led to some insights that help to improve the design or XAI method	The prototype test / user study has led to relevant insights for improvement of the design from a user-perspective or about XAI methods
And	And	And
The prototype test / user study is not documented in a way that allows for repeating of the process and drawing of conclusions.	The prototype test is documented but leaves some room for variation with regard to repeating the process or drawing conclusions.	The prototype test / user test is documented in a way that allows the reader to repeat the process of execution and drawing of conclusions

- [Design concept, 4 points] Are capable of communicating the (redesigned) concept, the use of the concept by the target group, and the experience of using the concept; alternatively: insights in XAI methods from the user study.

Poor (0 points)	Acceptable (2 points)	Good (4 points)
No visualization of the final design concept is provided, or the relation to user needs is missing.	The final design concept is presented using images and explanations, but the relation to the user needs and XAI techniques is somewhat weak or unclear.	The final design concept is presented using clear images and appropriate explanations that relate to the user needs and XAI techniques
And	And	And
The interaction of the user with the concept is not visualized.	The interaction of the user with the concept is visualized, but not within the use-context.	The interaction of the user with the concept is visualized in the use-context.

The design ARCHIVE (20 points)

In the design archive, we want to be able to see that you:

- [Structure, 8 points] Can provide a complete archive of the user research, which is clearly structured and easy to navigate;

Poor (0 points)	Acceptable (5 points)	Good (8 points)
An overview of the archive is unavailable or incomplete. And There is no clear structure to the archive.	An overview of the archive is provided concisely or unclearly. And The structure of the archive itself (folder / file names etc.) is not very clear.	A clear and complete overview of the archive is provided (i.e. what does the archive contain, where can we find what). And The archive as a whole is clearly structured and easy to navigate.

- [Transparence, 12 points] Can provide a transparent archive, including the methods, materials and results of the user research, and the notes you took throughout your design process;

Poor (0 points)	Acceptable (7points)	Good (12 points)
No method overview is provided, or it is not complete. And No materials are provided, or not all of them are provided. And Raw data is not provided, or the set of raw data is not complete.	For each iteration a method overview is provided, and it contains all the necessary sections, but the descriptions are not clear or complete. And Materials are described, but the original materials are not provided. And 'Raw' user research data is provided, but it is not really the raw data (i.e. it has been processed somehow, e.g. transcripts/notes instead of recordings)	A comprehensive set of methods (short description of each method, the recruitment process, the sample, when the research was executed, how raw data were gathered and then digitized) is provided where possible. And A comprehensive set of materials (e.g. probe materials, interview guide, observation scheme) is provided where possible. And A comprehensive set of raw, unprocessed user research data (e.g. Scans of diaries, audio/video recordings) is provided where possible

TABLE OF CONTENTS

In the design report, we suggest that you follow this table of contents (page suggests include limited amount of pictures/tables and are not strict but a guideline):

1. Introduction (1-2 page)
 - Description of the conducted assignment
 - Design debrief
2. Empathize phase: (2-4 page)
 - A well-argued and detailed description of the conducted pilot testing and qualitative user research methods (if any), or review of XAI tools/techniques or literature.
 - Results of the (qualitative) analysis / conclusion.
3. Define phase (1 page)
 - A well-argued description of the XAI techniques and user needs chosen to focus on in the ideation phase
4. Ideation phase (3-4 pages),
 - Description of the creative techniques used for divergence and convergence
 - Result of the divergence and convergence technique - A well-argued description of the chosen solution
5. Prototype phase (2-3 page)
 - A well-argued description of the developed prototype, including images of the prototype
6. Test phase (4 page)
 - A well-argued and detailed description of the conducted qualitative user research methods used for testing the prototype.
 - Research question
 - Results of the data analysis
7. Conclusions and recommendations (4 pages)
 - Conclusion of the user testing
 - A well-argued description of the final prototype, including visualizations
 - Visualization of the interaction of the user with the concept in the use-context.
8. Short description of design archive
 - Method overview, references to the archive that contains materials used in user research (e.g. probe materials, interview guide, observation scheme), the notes you took throughout your design process and collected RAW data.

Rubric for the design market (30 points):

- Oral presentation of the design concept

Points: 15	Points: 8	Points: 0
A compelling case is made for the design concept, illustrating the way the research led to insights about users' needs and XAI techniques, and identifying a specific, salient and important 'problem-area', based on own empirical data, supplemented with literature	A case is made for the design concept, summarizing empirically driven insights about users' needs and XAI techniques and identifying a specific 'problem area' that the design concept will tap into	No rationale is given for the design concept

- Visual presentation of the Design Concept

Points: 15	Points: 8	Points: 0
The design concept is illustrated in an informative and captivating way, catching the viewer's imagination	The design concept is illustrated in an informative way, making clear what the product / design	No visual materials are used to present the design concept